SOC INCIDENT REPORT

Brute-Force Login Attempt (Simulated)

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1. Incident Overview

Incident Title:
Brute-Force Login Attempt (Simulated)

Incident Type:
Authentication Attack – Brute Force

Date & Time:
15 January 2026, between 19:30:48 and 19:31:09 IST

Reported By:
SOC Analyst (Lab Environment)

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2. Affected Asset

System:
Windows Operating System (Virtual Machine)

Log Source:
Windows Security Event Logs

SIEM Platform:
Elastic SIEM (Kibana)

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3. Detection Method

The incident was detected through **manual monitoring of Windows authentication logs** in Elastic SIEM.

Event ID Observed:

- **4625** – Failed login attempt

A saved monitoring view for failed authentication events was used to observe repeated login failures.

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4. Incident Description

Multiple failed login attempts were observed for the same user account within a short time window. The failed attempts occurred consecutively without any successful authentication events following them. This activity pattern indicates a potential brute-force login attempt.

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5. Investigation Details

The following indicators were analyzed during the investigation:

- Username targeted in the failed login attempts
- Hostname of the affected system
- Timestamps of each failed authentication event
- Frequency and repetition of failures

Key Findings:

- Repeated failed login attempts targeting a single user
- Attempts occurred close together in time
- No successful login events (Event ID 4624) observed after failures

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6. Analysis

Based on the investigation, the activity pattern matches a **brute-force authentication attempt**. The absence of successful logins after repeated failures indicates that the attack was unsuccessful.

As this activity was generated intentionally in a controlled lab environment, it is classified as a **simulated incident**.

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7. Severity Assessment

Severity Level: Medium

Reasoning:
The activity demonstrated malicious intent through repeated authentication failures but did not result in account compromise or system access.

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8. Response Taken

No containment or remediation actions were required, as the incident occurred in a controlled lab environment for learning purposes.

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9. Recommendations

If this activity were observed in a production environment, the following actions are recommended:

- Enable account lockout policies after multiple failed login attempts
- Monitor authentication failure events continuously
- Enforce strong password policies
- Review user accounts for abnormal login behavior

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10. Incident Status

Current Status: Closed
Closure Reason: Simulated lab activity with no impact

Analyst Notes

This incident demonstrates the importance of monitoring authentication logs to detect early signs of brute-force attacks. Proper log visibility and investigation enable SOC teams to identify suspicious behavior before successful compromise occurs.